P05

Quorum Sensing and Collective Decision-Making in Honeybees

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Abstract

Honeybee swarms choose among prospective nesting sites using waggle dances that represent site quality. When scout bees observe that visitor numbers at a site surpass a quorum threshold, they initiate piping signals that coordinate liftoff without any central census.

Abstract quoted from T. D. Seeley et al., Science (2004).

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